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Top Skills

Database Administration

PostgreSQL

Infrastructure as code (IaC)

Languages

Sanskrit (Limited Working)

Tamil (Professional Working)

English (Full Professional)

Hindi (Native or Bilingual)

Certifications

Oracle Certified Associate

AWS Certified Database – Specialty

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure
Foundations 2021 Certified
Associate

Big Data - Administration

CKA: Certified Kubernetes
Administrator

Honors-Awards

Extra Milestone Award

Top Performer Recognition

Sumeet Shukla

Staff Database Reliability Engineer (DBRE) | PostgreSQL & Multi-Cloud Architect | GCP CloudSQL/AlloyDB, AWS RDS/Aurora | Scaling Platforms via Terraform, Kubernetes | HA/DR, Performance, Automation, Cost Optimization

Pune, Maharashtra, India

Summary

Staff Database Reliability Engineer with 12+ years of experience designing, operating, and modernizing large-scale database platforms across cloud and on-prem environments. I specialize in PostgreSQL performance engineering, cloud-native database reliability, and platform-level automation, operating at Staff scope across infrastructure, security, and delivery pipelines.

I've consistently delivered measurable business impact, including:

- Up to 99% reduction in query execution time across critical workloads
- Zero-downtime PostgreSQL and infrastructure upgrades
- Significant cost savings through capacity planning, tuning, and automation
- Improved deployment velocity through Terraform and CI/CD restructuring

My technical depth spans:

- PostgreSQL internals, query planning, indexing, partitioning, memory tuning
- Cloud SQL (GCP), AWS RDS & Aurora PostgreSQL at scale
- Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Packer)
- Kubernetes-based automation for database operations
- Database CI/CD (Flyway, GitHub Actions, CircleCI)
- Security hardening (SSL enforcement, access control, auditability)
- HA/DR design, incident response, and operational readiness

I operate with high autonomy and ownership, often leading ambiguous, high-impact initiatives end-to-end - from problem discovery and design to rollout and long-term standardization. I'm trusted to own production-critical systems, guide architectural

decisions, and raise the bar through clear documentation, mentoring, and cross-functional collaboration.

At Staff level, my focus is on platform thinking: reducing toil, increasing reliability, enabling teams to move faster, and building database foundations that scale with the business.

Experience

Inspectorio

Senior Database Reliability Engineer

March 2025 - Present (10 months)

India

- Own database reliability, performance, and scalability for production-critical, multi-cloud data platforms, including PostgreSQL on GCP Cloud SQL & AlloyDB, Kafka, MongoDB, and Elasticsearch, supporting 25+ production instances across environments.
- Lead deep PostgreSQL performance engineering, delivering up to 99% improvement in query execution times and ~90% latency reduction on critical workloads through SQL rewrites, advanced indexing, bloat remediation, memory tuning, and server-level optimization.
- Provide technical leadership and strategic direction for database platforms, defining standards, roadmaps, and best practices to evolve databases from service-level dependencies into a scalable, governed platform aligned with long-term business goals.
- Refactor and modernize Terraform infrastructure into product-aligned workspaces, eliminating CI/CD timeouts, improving deployment speed and reliability, and reducing long-term maintenance risk.
- Execute zero-downtime database and Terraform module upgrades, ensuring safe rollouts, backward compatibility, and uninterrupted production operations.
- Build end-to-end DB-Ops automation for PostgreSQL fleet management (health checks, bloat detection, automated reindexing, vacuum/analyze, upgrade preflight checks), reducing manual DBA effort and preventing recurring production regressions.

- Design Kubernetes-based automation frameworks (CronJobs) to operationalize routine database maintenance and reduce manual toil at scale.
- Drive security hardening, observability, and SLO-driven operations, enforcing SSL-only connectivity, leading blameless incident postmortems, and acting as primary incident lead.
- Partner closely with SRE, Platform, and Product Engineering teams to proactively scale database systems, reduce operational risk, and enable reliable product growth.
- Recognized by managers and peers for independent execution, strong documentation, and calm leadership during high-severity incidents.

Hexaware Technologies

Lead Database Reliability Engineer

February 2024 - March 2025 (1 year 2 months)

India

- Led end-to-end transition, stabilization, and steady-state ownership of enterprise data platforms across PostgreSQL, Snowflake, and SnapLogic on AWS, ensuring service continuity and zero critical outages during vendor handovers.
- Built, hired, and mentored a high-performing DBA / DBRE team, driving structured onboarding, knowledge transfer (KT), and operational readiness for large-scale enterprise clients.
- Designed and implemented cloud-native operating models using AWS services and Terraform-based Infrastructure as Code, enabling standardized provisioning, repeatable environments, and reduced operational risk.
- Established platform governance, SLAs, runbooks, and operational best practices, improving support quality, reducing incident recurrence, and enabling reliable long-term service delivery.

Independent Consulting

Principal PostgreSQL Database Reliability Consultant

March 2022 - February 2024 (2 years)

India

I intentionally transitioned into independent consulting after relocating from Dubai to India to support my parents following my father's retirement. During this period, I focused on deepening my PostgreSQL and cloud platform expertise across diverse, production-scale environments, enabling me to broaden my impact while remaining geographically flexible. This phase was a deliberate step before returning to a long-term platform leadership role.

Talabat

Senior Site Reliability Engineer (Database Platforms)

March 2019 - February 2022 (3 years)

Dubai, United Arab Emirates

- Database Infrastructure Strategy (IaC): Architected global-scale AWS RDS and Aurora infrastructure using Terraform, implementing modular patterns to standardize deployments, eliminate environment drift, and enforce "Infrastructure as Code" as the organizational source of truth.
- Scalable Infrastructure Orchestration: Scaled and optimized database-backed applications on Kubernetes (K8s) by defining resource quotas, persistent volume management, and pod affinity rules; ensured zero-downtime deployments and peak performance for high-traffic workloads.
- Staff-Level Advocacy & Developer Enablement: Aligned engineering teams through deep-dive workshops on SQL best practices, schema modeling, and indexing strategies. Established architectural guardrails for DB engine selection to eliminate performance debt at the design phase.
- Availability & Resilience (HA/DR): Spearheaded enterprise-grade HA/DR frameworks and led the migration from legacy RDS to Amazon Aurora. Improved failover times and read scalability by implementing automated maintenance and proactive monitoring environments.
- Performance Engineering & Observability: Established a comprehensive observability stack using CloudWatch, SNS, and RDS Performance Insights. Led high-impact query tuning and Root Cause Analysis (RCA) to transform incident data into permanent infrastructure hardening.
- Release Engineering & Operations Maturity: Partnered with DevOps to harden CI/CD pipelines in Azure DevOps/Octopus, integrating automated security (VPC, NACLs) and maturing Incident Management via OpsGenie/PagerDuty to reduce MTTR.

Optum

Senior Database Administrator

April 2017 - March 2019 (2 years)

Chennai Area, India

- Led and mentored a team of highly skilled PostgreSQL and MySQL DBAs, driving operational excellence across production environments.
- Conducted a comprehensive architectural and performance health assessment of the database infrastructure upon onboarding, identifying critical improvement areas.
- Delivered up to 150% performance improvement on PostgreSQL workloads through OS-level tuning, database configuration optimization, and query performance enhancements.
- Achieved up to 70% performance improvement on MySQL systems by optimizing server configurations, storage, and database parameters.
- Owned the end-to-end lifecycle of PostgreSQL and MySQL platforms, including installation, upgrades, configuration, replication, and ongoing maintenance.
- Designed and implemented capacity planning, high-availability, and disaster-recovery architectures to meet enterprise reliability and compliance requirements.
- Collaborated closely with engineering teams and business stakeholders to plan and implement robust backup, recovery, and database security strategies.
- Worked with AWS RDS and Aurora, configuring Foreign Data Wrappers and automating routine database operations to improve efficiency and consistency.
- Provided cross-platform database support as needed, including Microsoft SQL Server and MongoDB, to meet evolving application and business requirements.

Cisco

PostgreSQL DBA

August 2016 - April 2017 (9 months)

Bangalore

PostgreSQL DBA – Cisco EMaaS (Energy Management as a Service)

- Installed, configured, replicated, and maintained PostgreSQL databases supporting Cisco's cloud-based EMaaS platform.
- Implemented PostgreSQL High Availability and Disaster Recovery architectures to ensure service reliability and continuity.
- Planned and executed database backup, recovery, and security strategies aligned with enterprise standards.
- Performed PostgreSQL performance tuning, optimizing server parameters and configurations for scalable workloads.
- Implemented and managed monitoring and administration tools including Nagios, pgBadger, pgAdmin, pgPool-II, PEM, and OPM.
- Conducted regular database health checks and proactively resolved performance and stability issues.
- Automated routine DBA operations using shell scripting, improving efficiency and consistency.
- Supported containerized environments using Docker and gained foundational exposure to MongoDB administration.

ThoughtBirds Technologies LLP

Founder Director

November 2013 - July 2016 (2 years 9 months)

Pune Area, India

- Co-founded and led an IT services startup, owning the full lifecycle from client acquisition and commercial negotiations to solution architecture, delivery, and support across multiple engagements.
- Designed, deployed, and maintained PostgreSQL database environments, including installation, configuration, performance tuning, and ongoing operations.
- Planned and implemented backup, recovery, and security strategies, ensuring data integrity and service continuity for client systems.

- Automated operational tasks using shell scripting, improving delivery efficiency and reducing manual overhead.
- Coordinated with technical teams to plan and execute system upgrades, patches, and production changes.
- Optimized performance of WordPress and Magento platforms through database tuning, application configuration, and infrastructure improvements.
- Built hands-on expertise across cloud and big-data technologies, including AWS, Hadoop, HDFS, MapReduce, Hive, Pig, HBase, Sqoop, Flume, and Zookeeper.
- Led the design and development of web applications using PHP, HTML, CSS, JavaScript/jQuery, and CMS platforms (WordPress, Magento).
- Implemented Scrum-based agile delivery, leveraging open-source project management tools to improve planning, execution, and team collaboration.
- Recruited, trained, and managed a cross-functional team of four engineers, developing foundational people-management and leadership skills.

Xento Systems Pvt. Ltd

Associate Engineer

October 2012 - October 2013 (1 year 1 month)

- Supported production and non-production PostgreSQL databases, resolving live database issues in close collaboration with application developers.
- Monitored and managed PostgreSQL environments across development and staging, ensuring availability and operational stability.
- Created, updated, and maintained database schemas, users, and objects to support application requirements.
- Performed database backup and restoration activities to ensure data integrity and recoverability.
- Optimized and tuned SQL queries, improving application performance and query efficiency.

- Contributed to the development of dynamic web applications using PHP, HTML, CSS, and jQuery, supporting a rental business platform.

Tata Consultancy Services

Assistant System Engineer

July 2007 - February 2010 (2 years 8 months)

I have been providing BI solution support to Enterprises using Oracle 9i and Business Objects product suites including Enhancement and Support for reports in Business Objects, Crystal Reports environment.

Education

University of Pune

Master's Degree, Computer/Information Technology Administration and Management · (2010 - 2013)

Annamalai University

Bachelor's Degree, Computer Programming, Specific Applications · (2008 - 2010)

Anna University

Diploma, Electrical & Electronics Engineering · (2004 - 2007)

Govt. Higher Secondary School, Dirang

High School · (2003 - 2004)